

ALGEBRA TRIGGER-NOMETRY

~~METH~~-odology → MATH-ematics

My favorite interview I've had this year —

VP, ENTERPRISE SALES — ON HIS QUOTA

"I want my quota to produce more math than meth."

He sold me at meth — I mean math!! Get your mind out of the gutter, people ;)

Here's the story of how I turned a product catalog that looked like it was **cooked up in Breaking Bad** into an algebraic expression.

2M+

SKUS TO UNTANGLE

200+

PRICING EQUATIONS

I

RULE ENGINE THAT SHIPPED

2015. My first Accenture engagement. A global education publisher. Total chaos.

Their systems of record captured flat ISBN codes. But the products themselves were anything but flat.

2M+

product SKUs in the U.S. higher-ed catalog

I : I

new ISBN minted per product variation

EVERY ONE OF THESE PRODUCED A NEW SKU

Physical print

Digital versions

Supplemental materials

Student vs. teacher

Learning vs. testing

...and service projects

"Online learning was being sold through systems built for print books and physical inventory."

WHAT I BUILT

Algebra. Not architecture diagrams.

This is where the "meth-odology" converts to math.

An 8-tab workbook. ~200 algebraic equations. One variable for every product version.

THE PRICING DEFINITION

$n \text{ (price)} = f(x, y, z, u)$

x static print retail price

y matrix license pricing

$z = x + [x \cdot \text{defined price factor}]$

$u = x + [x \cdot \text{defined price factor}]$



I got laughed at for presenting algebraic formulas instead of fancy architecture diagrams.

8

WORKBOOK TABS

200+

EQUATIONS



IT WORKED

”

Meth sells. But it's the math that turns the meth into a **consistent operational process** — pipeline, proposal, contract, fulfillment, invoice, revenue, cash.

So maybe it's not "it's not meth, it's math." Maybe it's —
meth + math = solution.

Most answers aren't "one or the other." The hidden solution is the equation you build when you combine both variables to equal your business target.

LET'S TALK

Can you think of anywhere else right now where the answer seems like it has to be one option or the other?